



ILLUSTRATION BY ANIRBAN GHOSH

ers, and designers of platforms that have solutions, products, components and devices that span the entire digital economy ecosystem.

The global demand for digital products and services will lead to a demand for digital talent. One of the key focus areas for us is that we want Indian talent to be not just low-cost talent (as was the case with IT/ITeS earlier), but really be the best-in-class, leading the way in new areas of high-performance computing, AI computing, blockchain... where talent and quality of talent are the determining factors. Today, every enterprise, government and consumer is competing. Technology is the enabler of competitiveness and everyone wants the best talent to design, construct, develop and execute their platforms and solutions.

Another key trend is that young

people will not be heading to Silicon Valley, rather there will be significant interest for them to come and work in India. There is going to be almost a tectonic change from India being an exporter of talent to Indian talent wanting to cooperate with the rest of the world and build the solutions and ideas of the future. The underlying premise of all this is that the intensity of tech in our lives, in enterprises, and business models is only going to get deeper.

The Prime Minister's objectives were very clear in 2015 that he wanted technology to transform the lives of our citizens in terms of governance and democracy, and be an enabler of opportunities for young Indians. Even I did not believe that we would travel this far. That we would emerge as one of the pre-eminent nations to use tech for governance and develop-

ment, and the world would look at us as a trusted partner in technology. So much so that we would be at a stage where seven countries of the world would want the India Stack to be implemented in their systems. This is the same country (India) that just some years ago would buy everything from the US or the UK or Germany, as the case may be.

But the narrative has turned on its head now. The statement of UAE's digital minister, "The future of technology will have Indian fingerprints everywhere" aptly captures the India story, and shows how the world is looking at India, today. **BT**

*As told to Nidhi Singal.
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